

or a headphone port. The weight of Echo is 1064 grams, which is of course lighter than HomePod. When it comes to the price, the Amazon Echo priced at \$179.99 which is cheaper than the HomePod. You can buy two Echo's for the price of one HomePod.

Google Home (http://dgit.in/home_speaker) is a smart voice assistant powered by Google Assistant, which is included with Android platform and the Google Allo app. You can ask Home to do tasks in the same way as HomePod and Echo. The Home speaker pulls information from Google. The search engine giant is expected to provide support for hands-free calling within the next few months.

The big advantage of Google Home is that it is compatible with both Android and iOS unlike HomePod, which provides support for only iOS. You can play music and podcasts from Spotify, Pandora, YouTube Music, Google Play Music and many other services. The highlight of Google Home is



Interact with HomePod and get instant information via Siri

that you can establish seamless connectivity with Chromecast to enable you to play movies and videos to your TV by just asking the speaker to do it. Moreover, you can also play with Nest and Philips Hue to set temperature and switch off lights. When compared with Apple HomePod and Amazon Echo, the Google Home measures only 477 grams and also priced at an affordable cost at \$129. The availability of all the three speakers is still a matter of concern in countries like India.

Could there be anything wrong with it?

Limited OS version support is a concern with HomePod. Currently the speaker provides support for devices running only iOS 11. If you work with an iPhone with older iOS platform, you will not be able to interact with the speaker. The inability to provide support for non-iOS devices is also a big con. The cost of the speaker is expensive when compared to Amazon Echo and Google Home. Whether or not the price tag is worthwhile will be decided this December. So stay tuned. **d**